

1.2.a. Diet and nutrition and their effect on physical activity and performance

Learners will develop their knowledge and understanding of the components and functions of a balanced diet, as well as being able to relate diet, hydration and dietary supplements to performance in physical activities and sports.

Knowledge and understanding will also be developed of ergogenic aids and how they are used to improve sports performance.

Topic Area	Content
Diet and nutrition 	• function and importance of the components of a healthy, balanced diet: ◦ carbohydrates ◦ proteins ◦ fats ◦ minerals ◦ vitamins ◦ fibre ◦ water • energy intake and expenditure and energy balance in physical activity and performance.
Ergogenic aids 	• use of ergogenic aids; potential benefits and risks: ◦ pharmacological aids: – anabolic steroids – erythropoietin (EPO) – human growth hormone (HGH) ◦ physiological aids: – blood doping, – intermittent hypoxic training (IHT) – cooling aids

Topic Area	Content
Ergogenic aids cont. 	○ nutritional aids: – amount of food – composition of meals – timing of meals – hydration – glycogen/carbohydrate loading – creatine – caffeine – bicarbonate – nitrate.